

Corona is another powerful framework for the development of cross-platform mobile apps compatible with multiple devices and operating systems, including Amazon Fire, Windows, Android, Mac and many others. Lua is the base programming language for Corona based development — it is a free and open source language with lightweight features.

The Corona SDK can be downloaded free from <https://developer.coronalabs.com/sites/default/files/Corona-2018.3326.msi>. The Corona IDE is easy to use and very effective.

To download the Corona SDK, a free account can be created on the portal. After registration and successfully logging in, the Corona SDK can be downloaded with all the options to create the mobile app.

Creating a new project: To create a new project, select 'New Project' from the IDE of Corona. It will open a directory structure with a main file titled *main.lua*. In this *main.lua* file, the code for the smartphone app is to be written by the developer.

The following is the sample code to display a text on the screen of the mobile phone using Lua:

Display Text on Mobile

```
--
-- main.lua
--
display.newText("Hello World!", 100, 0, native.systemFont,
16);
```

On relaunching the emulator, the new output is presented on the mobile screen displayed in the Corona SDK. In this way, the programmer can view the settings of the output and the required features, which are programmed in Lua code.

In the Corona mobile simulator, the option 'Open in Editor' is used to open and edit the source code of the Lua language so that new functions can be added to the application. After all the editing and changes are done, finally, the option 'Build' is used so that the executable file can be prepared for the specific device.

Scope for research and development

For research and development, the performance of mobile apps can be evaluated on multiple cross-platform frameworks. The same application can be developed using Cordova, Corona and other similar frameworks. After development and deployment on specific devices and platforms, the performance of these environments can be evaluated so that the best framework can be identified for the development of your mobile app. **END** 

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- Mobile Monkey:** Touted as the 'world's best Messenger marketing platform', Mobile Monkey builds on its strength of a wide user base by offering automated marketing techniques including customer segmentation, lead generation, 'blast chat' and other ideas to improve return on investments in advertisements.

A few other frameworks worth mentioning include PandoraBots, Floatbot.ai, ChatScript, Bottr, and Facebook's own bot-creation toolkit for Messenger. These have unique features but share common themes including analytics, deployment, and ease-of-use for non-technical users.

Scope for growth

The world of chatbots is gaining traction as novel approaches boost the accuracy of natural language understanding. Apart from being strong markers of where the future of technology is headed, these ideas paint an interesting picture of at least one clear way that bots are going to impact our lives. When Google had a demo of its voice assistant that has the capabilities to take calls

and book appointments on the owner's behalf, it received mixed responses after the applause died down and people had a moment to consider its implications. It was complicated – there are ethical implications at play when you set AI against what is most likely a human on the other end, with the latter having no information beforehand that he or she will be dealing with a chatbot. The discussions will continue possibly for a long time before we arrive at a consensus but it is important, as we bake automation into more and more systems, that developers recognise the responsibilities they shoulder as they launch an AI chatbot into the public domain. **END** 

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